

Manufacturing of silk

C. Wool

Wool is one of the oldest fibres used for protection from the cold climate. It is natural protein fibre and considered as Man's best friend. Sheep skin, including the hair, was probably used long before it was discovered that fibres could be spun into yarns or even felted into fabric.

DO YOU KNOW?

The earliest fragments of wool fabric have been found in Egypt but Mesopotamia is the birth place of wool.

Wool can be sheared from the living animal or pulled from the hide after the animal has been slaughtered for its meat. Sheared wool is called **Fleece** or **Clip wool** and wool taken from hides of slaughtered animal is called **pulled wool** which is inferior in quality to fleece or clip wool.

The quality of wool is expressed by numbers. The higher the numbers, the finer the wool and better the quality. The finest wool is from young sheep. Very fine wool of excellent quality is shorn from lambs when eight months old.

i. Manufacturing process:

Once the raw wool reaches the mills, is has to pass through many processes before it finally emerges as woolen cloth. Sorting, Scouring, Carbonizing, Carding, Spinning, Bleaching, Dyeing, Weaving, Knitting and Finishing.

a) **Sorting:** When the bales are opened, the fleece is graded. It may be separated into sections such as shoulders, sides etc.

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